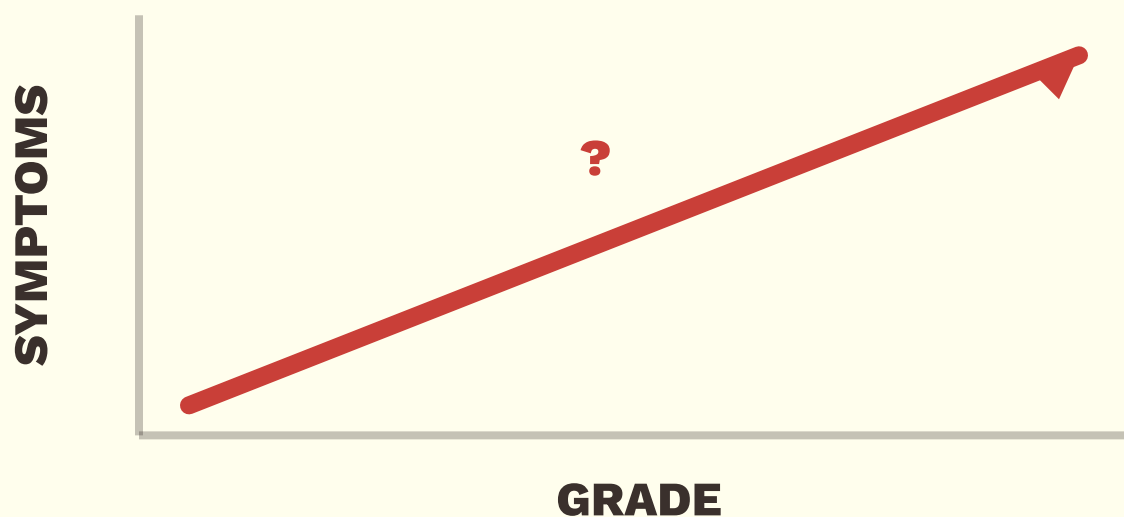


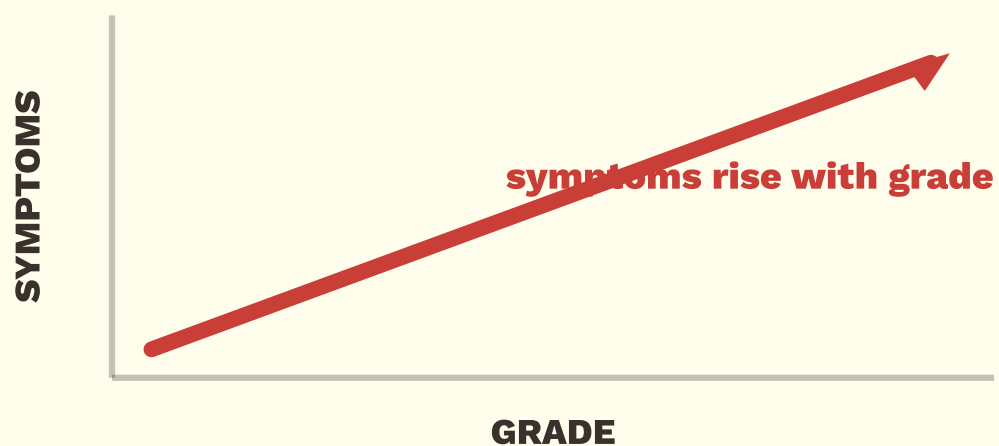
DOES A HIGHER GRADE MEAN **MORE PAIN?**

It is the assumption behind using symptoms to guide low risk shin bone stress. The evidence for it is two studies.



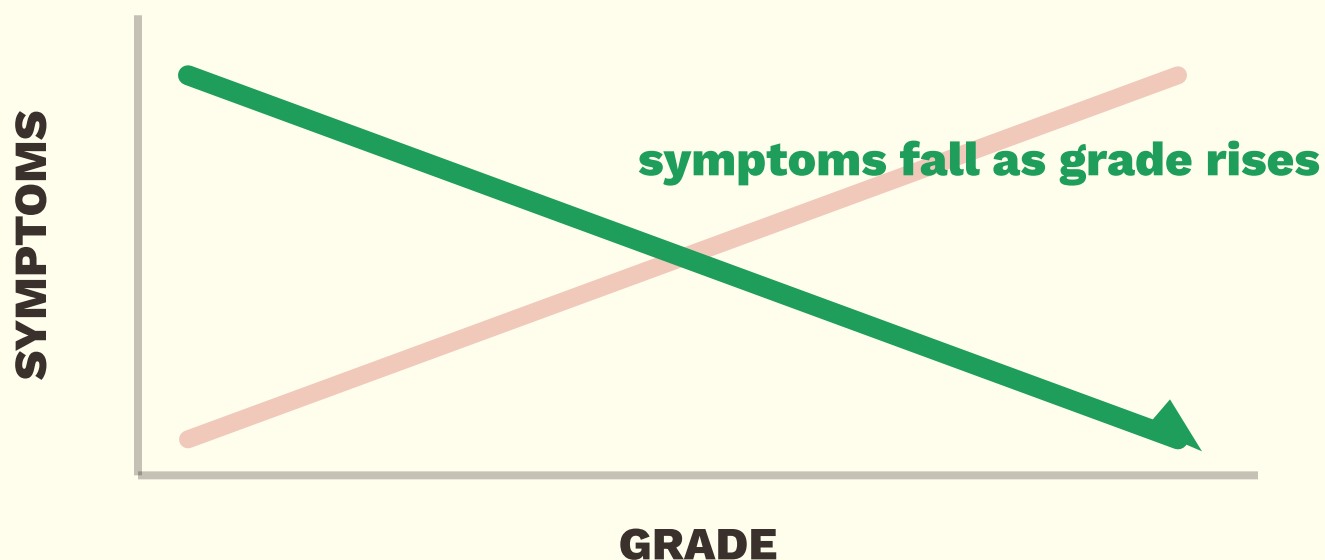
ONE STUDY SAYS **YES**

Fredericson and colleagues found lower grades gave diffuse tenderness, while higher grades gave more localised tenderness, and were more likely to hurt with percussion.



THE OTHER SAYS THE **OPPOSITE**

Beck and colleagues, looking more recently and more rigorously, found a higher grade was associated with **lower** clinical severity.

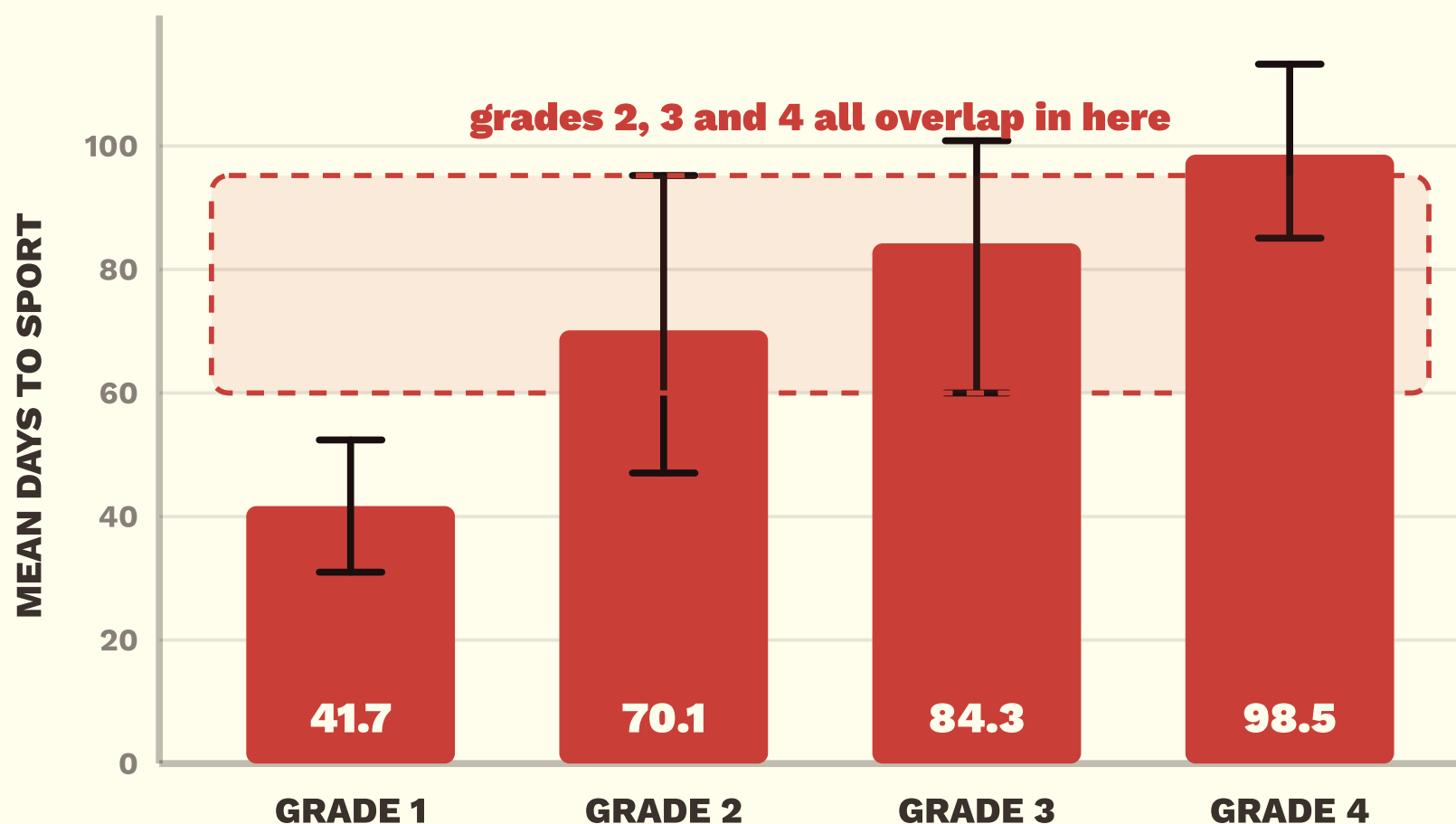


AND HERE IS ALL THE DATA **THERE IS**

	G0	G1	G2	G3	G4	TOTAL
Beck 2012	NA	7	11	18	1	37
Fredericson 1995	2	2	3	10	1	16

Grade 4 is the one with a fracture line. Between both studies, that is **two runners in total**.

GRADE DOES NOT EVEN CLEANLY PREDICT RECOVERY TIME



A grade 2 and a grade 4 can land on the same recovery time. If the grade cannot pin that down, expecting it to track how much something hurts is a stretch.

SO NOBODY SHOULD ANSWER THIS CONFIDENTLY

Two small studies. They disagree with each other. And almost none of the runners in them had an actual fracture.



Whatever symptoms tell us about a fracture, this is not the data that shows it.

SYMPTOMS ARE NOT **USELESS**

They are just one weak signal being asked to carry an entire decision, on evidence that was never strong enough for the job. There is more to weigh than pain.



~~pain alone~~

site

load

energy

More on that soon.